

G Arp

A tempo-locked MIDI arpeggiator with a 16-step pattern, accents, ties and a human feel.



Overview

G Arp turns the chords you hold into arpeggios. It sits in front of any instrument on the track and sends out the notes one at a time (or as repeated chords), in the order and rhythm you choose.

Each step of the 16-step pattern can be on, off (a rest), accented or tied to the step before, and has its own level. FEEL adds a human touch: a little timing looseness, velocity variation and a chance for steps to be skipped.

When the project plays, G Arp locks to the tempo and the timeline. When it is stopped, it runs free at the project tempo from the first key you press. Anything that isn't a note - controllers, pitch bend and so on - passes straight through.

Reach for it for

- Classic synth arpeggios from held chords
- Rhythmic gated chords (CHORD mode with a pattern)
- Sequenced basslines and plucks

- Latching a pattern while you play something else
- Adding loose, human movement to programmed parts

Setting it up

1. Insert G Arp in the track's FX chain, above (before) the instrument plugin. It takes MIDI in and sends MIDI on to the instrument; it does not touch audio.
 2. Arm the track and turn on record monitoring (or play MIDI items on the track). The MIDI light blinks green when notes arrive.
 3. Hold a chord: the display shows the step and the notes in the arpeggio. Press play to lock it to the project tempo; when stopped it runs at the project tempo from your first key.
 4. Switch ARP ON off to pass your notes straight through to the instrument.
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Controls

Left-hand strip

ARP ON	Turns the arpeggiator on (red light) or off. Off, your notes pass straight through; switching it off stops whatever it was playing.
LATCH	On: the arpeggio keeps playing after you let go of the keys. Release all keys and play a new chord to replace it. Turning LATCH off keeps only the keys you are still holding.
MIDI	Blinks green when a note arrives.
PATTERNS	Opens a menu of step patterns. Choosing one sets the step levels, accents and ties; the knobs and switches stay as they are (except Reset all to defaults).
S / M / L, ?	Panel size, and the pop-up with the design credit, the GFX website and the address of this manual (click anywhere to close it).

TIME

RATE	The length of each step: 1/4, 1/8, 1/8T, 1/16, 1/16T or 1/32 (T = triplet).
SWING	0 to 75%. Lengthens the first step of each pair and shortens the second, for a shuffle.
GATE	How long each note is held, as a percentage of its step, from 10% (short and staccato) to 200%. Above 100% each note overlaps the next, for a legato sound.

RANGE

OCTAVES	1 to 4. The arpeggio repeats the held notes this many octaves upwards.
STEPS	1 to 16: the length of the pattern. Steps beyond it are dimmed and skipped.

FEEL

TIMING	Humanised timing, 0 to 30 ms. Notes land a little late by varying amounts, with a slowly wandering feel rather than pure randomness.
VELOCITY	Humanised velocity, 0 to 40. Each note's velocity varies up or down by up to this amount.
CHANCE	0 to 100%: the chance that each step plays. Below 100% some steps are skipped at random.

NOTES

ACCENT	0 to 60: how much velocity an accented step adds.
LEVEL	1 to 127: the velocity used when the velocity source is FIXED.

Display and modes

Display	The top line shows the mode, rate and octaves. The bottom line shows the current step and the notes in the arpeggio, PLAY A CHORD when nothing is held, or ARP OFF - THRU.
UP / DOWN	The held notes from lowest to highest, or highest to lowest, through all the octaves.
UP-DN / DN-UP	Up then down, or down then up, without repeating the top and bottom notes.
PLAYED	The notes in the order you played them.
RANDOM	A random note from the set on every step.
CHORD	The whole chord on every step; with OCTAVES above 1 each step moves up an octave in turn.
VEL: PLAYED / FIXED / PATTERN	Click to choose where the velocity comes from: the velocity you played each key with, the LEVEL knob, or each step's level in the pattern display.

The step pattern

Step display	The bars above the buttons show each step's level. Click and drag in the display to draw the levels; drag a bar right to the bottom to make it a rest. The level sets the velocity in PATTERN mode. Shift+click a bar to accent it (a red cap), right-click to tie it (TIE). The step playing now is lit.
Step buttons 1 - 16	Click to turn a step on or off (it remembers its level). Shift+click to accent it - its number shows a > sign. Right-click to tie it to the step before: the previous note is held on through this step instead of a new one playing.

Patterns

Straight	Every step on at full level.
Offbeat accents	Every step on, with accents on steps 3, 7, 11 and 15.

Gallop	Rests on steps 2, 6, 10 and 14: a galloping rhythm.
Trance gate	A syncopated on / off gate pattern across the 16 steps.
Rise	Every step on, with levels rising from 35% to full across the bar.
Random	Random levels, with about a quarter of the steps resting and a few random accents. Each choice gives a new pattern.
Tied pairs	Rests on steps 4, 8, 12 and 16, with steps 2, 6, 10 and 14 tied to the step before.
Reset all to defaults	Every step on, and all the knobs and switches back to their starting values.

Tips

- The step levels only change the velocity when VEL is set to PATTERN; the pattern's rests, accents and ties work in every velocity mode.
- Try CHORD mode with a short GATE and the Trance gate pattern for rhythmic, gated chords.
- Set STEPS to an odd length (say 5 or 7) against a 1/16 RATE for patterns that shift against the bar.
- Your pattern is saved with the project.

File: gfx-g-arpeggiator.jsfx